> are not union-oriented and are less likely to raise safety concerns. Safety standards for some contractors have been found to be lower than other workers, as they received less training and induction.
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> At the core of the CFMEU's dispute with BHP Billiton-Mitsubishi Alliance in the Bowen Basin is management's insistence on appointing health and safety officers who do not represent a workforce that is increasingly contract driven (CFMEU 2012).

Canadian Vale workers come from a tradition of very strong union action in health and safety. The right to know, the right to participate and the right to stop production are strongly held principles. The right to know means being informed of products and processes that represent safety hazards. The right to participate means active union participation and joint structures. The right to stop production means a worker's right to bring production to a halt in the face of a perceived danger. In bigger mines, some of the worker-elected members are freed from production jobs to do full-time health and safety. The worker health and safety representatives are fully trained by both multi-level courses offered in labour schools run by the unions and company training. These representatives act as trainers for the rest of the workforce, as well as playing a proactive role in the day-to-day monitoring of all health and safety issues. They participate fully in all inspections and accident or fatality investigations. All of the Canadian Vale workers participating in the survey were in agreement that their new employer's approach to health and safety was highly problematic, a view that was exacerbated by the reality of five fatalities in the Thompson and Sudbury operations since 2011. In the Canadian context, this statistic is truly shocking.

In Canada, joint health and safety committees are mandated by law, as are mine rescue teams, first response teams and full health and safety training for all workers. The person in command of the first response team can be from either the management or union side. In the event of an emergency, this person takes charge with orders that supersede the hierarchies in place for normal production routines. All of the other levels of security available in the community, from firefighters to ambulance services to police forces, can also be called on, depending on the scale of the emergency.

One of the first bilateral exchanges between Canadian and Brazilian Vale workers took two Canadian health and safety workers to visit Vale mining in Carajás and railway and port workers in São Luis. They wrote reports when they came back, but the big question posed for them by talking with Vale workers in Brazil was: 'How can Brazilian Vale workers fight for health and safety when